



Chloe Cho <chloecho@berkeley.edu>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Nicola Häffner

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Wed, Jan 13, 2021 at 3:10 AM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Nicola Häffner

Gender

Female

Nationality

German

Emailn.haeffner@web.de**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

I defended in October 2020 and waiting to receive my certificate at the moment

City, state, and country of residence

Wädenswil in the canton of Zurich, Switzerland

University education

PhD in infectiology as part of the microbiology and immunology program of the life science Zurich graduate school. Institutions during my PhD were the University of Zurich and the University Hospital Zurich. I defended in October 2020 and still waiting to receive the PhD certificate.

Master of Science in microbiology and biochemistry at the University of Göttingen in Germany. I graduated in March 2015.

Bachelor of Science in biology at the University of Regensburg in Germany. I graduated in September 2012.

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I have always been keen on spending time abroad to learn about new cultures, develop personally and contribute to diverse projects. I was lucky to gain some experiences abroad

already (ERASMUS, "A New Passage to India" program). However, the Science Corps Fellow program is a great opportunity for me to strengthen my teaching abilities and to get a deep insight into the scientific structures in other countries. After my PhD graduation I want to broaden my expertise away from the bench and towards science administration / coordination as well as teaching and education. The experiences I would gain from the Science Corps Fellow program are very valuable to build my career in this sector.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

After graduation from school I spent 2 months in Costa Rica to learn Spanish and to work in an orphanage as a volunteer. During my Bachelor studies, I spend the last year of my studies in Canterbury, England, with the ERASMUS program. And finally, during my Master studies, I got the scholarship "A new passage to India" that enabled me to spend 3 months in a research lab in Pune, India. All these experiences abroad strengthened my self confidence and my ability to quickly adapt to foreign settings. During my PhD I was without direct supervision, which boosted not only my independence, but also my communication skills. I learned to openly discuss scientific issues with my colleagues and search for suitable collaborators supporting my projects. I was lucky to work and publish with collaborators in England, Japan, the USA and Germany. Additionally, I was supervising several students during my PhD. Beside several block course students, I also had one Master student and one Summer School student to supervise for an extended period. I'm still in contact with some of my students to follow up their careers. Now, I'm participating in a mentoring program to support female refugees studying in Switzerland.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Administrative role in industry or academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

Regarding the selection "administrative role", I hope to get as much insights into scientific administration as well as coordination within the next 2 years as possible. I will start to work at the University hospital Zurich beginning of February 2021 to learn how to set up and run clinical trials. This experience will help me to get an entry into the administration sector. In the long go, I would like to have a project management / project coordinator role. I enjoy interacting with people from different backgrounds (scientific and non-scientific) and I hope to be kind of a bridge between society and science in the future. Therefore, I also ticked the boxes for science education and outreach. I gained first experiences in this field by participating in a citizen science course as well as the course "science in context" provided by the ETH. In both courses the focus was laid on the communication between science and society. In the long-term future, I hope to act as a communicator among scientists to support their research and between science and society to raise awareness of diverse topics that are otherwise difficult to get access without any scientific background.

CV/Resumé

[Resume_Nicola_Haffner.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Some other mailing list

If other, please specify.

1/13/2021

UC Berkeley Mail - New Science Corps Fellow Application: Nicola Häffner

Mail from the MIM PhD program coordinator

Sent from Science Corps